Mechatronic Sensors Trainer

Fundamental Labs – Encoders

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Caution

This equipment is designed to be used for educational and research purposes and is not intended for use by the public. The user is responsible for ensuring that the equipment will be used by technically qualified personnel only. Users are responsible for certifying any modifications or additions they make to the default configuration.

Mechatronic Sensors Trainer – Application Guide

Encoders Lab

Why Explore Encoders?

Encoders are key components in modern engineering systems; they allow us to convert rotational motion into electrical signals for precise control and feedback. They're widely used in robotics, automation, and consumer electronics, often attached to motors or rotating mechanisms to measure position, direction, and speed. Understanding how encoders work is essential for designing mechatronic systems that rely on signals from physical movement.

Background

This lab is part of the Fundamentals labs for the Mechatronic Sensors Trainer. These labs will guide you through the sensors that are part of the board and the ones that are provided as external sensors so you can understand how to read from the sensors, what they read, when they are used, and you feel comfortable using them. This will also include highlighting datasheets to learn how to interpret them and know what to look for.

Prior to starting this lab, please review the following concept review (located in Documents/Quanser/4_concept_reviews/),

- 4_concept_reviews/Mechatronics/**027_rotary_encoders**.

Getting Started

In this lab, you will use the **Sensors Trainer** to learn about the basics of the **Encoders**. The lab will guide you through the working principle of encoders, how to read and use them as well as using the datasheet to understand the sensor better.

Before you begin this lab, ensure that the following criteria are met:

- Make sure the Sensors Trainer has been setup and tested. See the Quick Start Guide (Quanser/2_quick_start_guides/sensors_trainer) for details on this step.
- You are familiar with the basics of the programming language you are using for this lab.
- Have your development environment ready,
    - If using Python, we recommend using Visual Studio Code.